The violence stopped as suddenly as it arose, 'which suggests that it was not quite as spontaneous as it appeared at first sight. Bhajan Lal had shown his strength and Haryana's position was not ignored again'. [15]

On 28 March 1984, the president of the DSGMC, H.S. Manchanda, pro-Congress and a bitter critic of the Akali Dal morcha, was shot dead in broad daylight at the busy ITO traffic crossing in Delhi. To deal with the worsening law and order situation, on 3 April the whole of Punjab was declared a disturbed area and the National Security Act was promulgated, giving powers to the police to detain people without producing them in court. The day this was done, a prominent member of the Bharatiya Janata Party, Harbans Lal Khanna, was killed at Amritsar.

The next day, 4 April, Vishva Nath Tiwari, a professor at Punjab University and a member of the Rajya Sabha, was shot dead in Chandigarh while on a morning walk. On 22 April, an air force officer was hacked to death in his home. On 26 April, a young Sikh motorcycle rider shot a Hindu commission agent in Bhikiwind village in Amritsar district, and in another similar incident, a Hindu shopkeeper was shot in Samadh Bhai village in Faridkot district.

On 30 April, former deputy superintendent of police Bachan Singh, who had reportedly tortured Amrik Singh while he was in police custody, was shot dead along with his wife and daughter. On 12 May, Romesh Chander, son of the late Lala Jagat Narain, was shot dead in Jalandhar. In the two months of April and May 1984, at least eighty persons were killed and 107 injured in Bhindranwale-led extremist activities. Some Hindus started growing beards and wearing turbans to save their lives. The Hindu industrialists of Punjab started thinking of moving their businesses to the neighbouring state of Haryana.

By early March 1984, Bhindranwale's armed men were freely moving in the Golden Temple complex, and some of them had taken positions at vantage points in nearby buildings and houses overlooking the complex. Gun positions around the Akal Takht were being prepared, and arms and ammunition were moving into the Akal Takht complex with the knowledge, if not connivance, of officials of the Punjab government. Maj. Gen. Shahbeg Singh, who